

Guardian promise: protecting every child

- At CRY, we stand firm in the belief that every child deserves a safe, joyful, and nurturing childhood. We strive to create a world where children can explore their full potential without fear—guided by the values of protection, dignity, and care. Our mission is to empower individuals and communities to uphold the rights of children and actively safeguard their well-being, ensuring that no child is left vulnerable to harm or neglect.



Why we protect

- ▶ To affirm and strengthen CRY's unwavering commitment to safeguarding every child.
- ▶ To ensure that care, safety, and the overall well-being of children remain central to all our actions and decisions.
- ▶ To establish a reliable protection system for all children involved in CRY's development programs.
- ▶ To define a clear code of conduct and procedures that prevent any harm or abuse by staff or associates.
- ▶ To equip all team members with the knowledge, tools, and confidence to uphold a safe environment for children at all times.



Safety starts with us

- ▶ Awareness- All CRY staff must know and follow the Child Safeguarding Policy. New staff are oriented; policy breaches may lead to action or termination. Leaders and HR ensure policy access and implementation.
- ▶ Prevention- Hiring avoids candidates who may risk child safety. Partners must follow CRY's child protection standards. Informed consent needed before using any child's images or stories. Ongoing training and understanding of protection procedures are required.
- ▶ Reporting- All abuse/suspensions must be reported within 24 hours. Reports go to DA, HR, or CEO as per SOPs. Confidentiality is maintained; no public disclosure without approval. Full cooperation in investigations is expected.
- ▶ Responding- CRY acts quickly—within 48 hours of a complaint. Proper investigations are led by designated teams. Violations may lead to disciplinary or legal action.

Boundaries that protect

CRY's Code of Conduct ensures every child's dignity, privacy, and safety. Staff must manage risks, respect diversity, and obtain consent before engaging with children or collecting their data. All communication must remain professional, avoiding exposure to inappropriate content or speculation. Any form of abuse, discrimination, or personal contact—physical or digital—is strictly prohibited. Children must not be involved in private errands, taken to isolated spaces, or employed in any way. The focus remains on safeguarding, respect, and child empowerment at all times. These guidelines ensure that children are always safe, respected, and empowered in every environment.



Secure moments: Event safety plans

Organizing child-centric events requires careful planning with a strong focus on safety, relevance, and inclusion. Events should have clear goals, involve children where possible, and be guided by realistic expectations. Two phases of risk assessment must be done—during planning and before execution. Parental consent and full child details, including medical and dietary needs, must be collected. Venues should be safe, legally compliant, weather-resistant, and equipped with clear signage, toilets, drinking water, fire safety, and medical support. Entrances and exits must be mapped, marked, and supported by trained volunteers. Travel must be secure, with proper escort ratios, and no child under 8 should travel alone. Escorts should match the child's gender. All volunteers must be trained, carry IDs, and follow safeguarding policies. Emergency plans should be in place. For public hearings, consent is vital, and care must be taken to protect the child's identity and emotional well-being, ensuring confidentiality and dignity at all times.

Digital Guardrails

1. Exposure to Inappropriate Content- Children must be protected from exposure to unsuitable materials on the internet, especially content that is sexually explicit, violent, or emotionally harmful.
2. Strict Prohibition on Online Abuse- Any form of online abuse, harassment, bullying, or exploitation of children is strictly prohibited. CRY enforces zero tolerance for such behaviors.
3. Informed Consent Before Sharing- Any sharing of a child's photograph, video, or personal story online must be preceded by informed written consent from both the child (if 14 years or older) and their parent/guardian. Children must have the right to say 'No' to being photographed or filmed.
4. Data Privacy and Security- Sensitive information about children must be handled with utmost confidentiality and must not be shared publicly unless approved by CRY's authorized personnel. No geo-tagging or sharing of identifiable location data in images or posts is permitted. This structured policy ensures a child-safe digital environment and reinforces CRY's strong stance on protecting children from online harm.

Frame of Consent

1. Informed and Written Consent- Consent must be taken in writing from both the child and parent/guardian before capturing or using any image or video.
2. Age-Appropriate Understanding- Children must understand the purpose; those above 14 must give individual consent, and younger children need guardian approval.
3. No Pressure or Incentives- No financial or material inducements should be offered for obtaining consent.
4. Right to Withdraw- Children and parents can withdraw consent at any time, and the use of their data must stop accordingly.
5. Respectful and Dignified Representation- Children must be portrayed respectfully, not in submissive, indecent, or distressing ways. Children must be clothed appropriately, and visuals must not exploit their vulnerability.
6. Privacy Protection- Avoid disclosing full names, addresses, or geolocation. Never use identifiable details in sensitive cases

Spotlight with Safety

Working with child actors requires strict adherence to safety, legal, and ethical guidelines. Child actors under 18 must not work beyond 5 hours a day, with at least one-hour breaks, and are not allowed to work between 7 p.m. and 8 a.m. Legal approval from the District Magistrate and written parental consent are mandatory. Children must receive safe shelter, nutritious food, clean facilities, emotional support, and access to medical care. Education must not be disrupted for more than 27 days, and 20% of the child's earnings must be secured in their name. One trained adult should supervise a maximum of five children. Children must never be forced to perform or exposed to inappropriate content, and a parent or guardian must always be present during shoots to ensure their safety and well-being.



The Voice-line protocol

CRY's Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) provides a clear process for addressing any child protection concerns. Anyone—including staff, volunteers, parents, or community members—can report suspected abuse, violations, or risks. Internal incidents must be reported within 24 hours, while external ones (not directly involving CRY staff or projects) must be reported within 5 days to designated authorities or HR. The severity of the concern is assessed, and appropriate actions are taken, such as internal investigation, suspension, police reporting, termination, or legal proceedings. Throughout the process, strict confidentiality is maintained, and the emotional well-being of the child is prioritized through counseling and support. If the case falls outside CRY's jurisdiction, it is escalated to statutory child protection bodies to ensure timely and lawful intervention. The SOP reinforces CRY's commitment to creating a safe, accountable, and child-centric environment.



Summary

A Child Safeguarding Policy in an NGO context outlines the commitment and responsibility of the organization to protect children from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and harm in all its activities. It ensures that all children the NGO interacts with are safe, respected, and treated with dignity. This policy includes clear guidelines on appropriate behavior when working with children, procedures for reporting concerns, and vetting processes for staff, volunteers, and partners. It emphasizes child rights, prioritizes the child's best interests, and promotes a safe environment across all programs, events, and digital platforms. Additionally, the policy requires regular training for staff, fosters a culture of accountability, and encourages community involvement in protecting children. By implementing this policy, the NGO actively upholds its ethical responsibility and legal duty to safeguard every child under its care or influence.

